

The ATS Translation Layer

Use the language of the role without borrowing experience you do not have.

THE DECISION

A résumé can be both readable to a person and legible to a system when its language mirrors the real responsibilities, tools and outcomes of the target role. Translation is not keyword stuffing; it is honest alignment.

THREE MOVES

→ Circle repeated nouns and verbs in the role description, then map each to evidence already present in your career.

→ Use the employer's plain-language term when it accurately describes your work; keep your original terminology where it does not.

→ Remove unsupported keywords that would be difficult to explain in a follow-up conversation.

TRY THIS BEFORE YOUR NEXT STEP

Create a two-column note: “role language” on the left and “my proof” on the right. Keep only matches you can defend.

Reading note: This is a sample briefing for educational reading. It is not a historic newsletter send and does not guarantee an interview, offer or outcome. Framework reference: [University of Michigan Career Center — Interviewing Resources](#).